Tibet and to secure India's recognition of the new reality through a formal agreement. The second chapter looks at the objectives of India and China in Tibet, and their respective diplomatic strategies in meeting those objectives over a region in which both had vital national interests.

The third chapter deals with the diplomatic fall-out of India's five nuclear tests on 11 and 13 May 1998. China's initially anodyne statement after the first two tests on 11 May was followed days later by a full-throated Chinese condemnation, and led to their crafting of an initiative to isolate India internationally. This was not the first occasion for the two sides to interact on nuclear issues—the Chinese tests in the 1960s and the Indian 'peaceful nuclear explosion' in 1974 were part of our earlier diplomatic discourse, but this time it was different. As India and China jousted on the multilateral stage, the chapter examines the strategies that China followed, and how they dealt with India both multilaterally and bilaterally until normal state-to-state relations could be restored in 2001.

The reference by China to Sikkim as a 'State of India' in the India–China Joint Statement of 11 April 2005 concluded a very long and interesting diplomatic negotiation between India and China. This forms the content of the fourth chapter of the book. Differences had cropped up in the 1950s when China introduced deliberate ambiguity into the status of Sikkim, while avoiding any direct discussion of it with India. The fourth chapter looks at how China dealt with India after the merger of Sikkim with India in 1975 changed the status quo, including how both sides drew upon their past experiences to fashion the best possible outcome in the negotiations. It also looks at how China adjusted tactics and negotiating briefs in the pursuit of its objectives.

By 2008 the gap between India and China in terms of comprehensive national power had visibly widened and China